ENTANGLEMENT

Selected Works 2021-2024

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Brera Academy

CONTENTS

1.Creative art and instal-lation art

Involution & Rat race

2.Cultural-creative design & visual communication de-sign

Dreams

3.Extra media visual communication art

Food Synergy-Mundus Cibi

4.Historical clothing

Cultural Heritage based Art

5.Paintings with Pastels

6.Recent work

CREATIVE ART
AND
INSTALLATION ART

Involution & Rat race

Introduction

Clock in City Abyss

2022-Sept. 2023

60cm*47cm

cardboard, picture frame, acrylic, coloured pencil, clock

This work reflects a contemplation of the current phenomenon of societal "involution." The clock symbolizes the passage of a person's lifetime, bearing witness to it, yet it remains relentless and cold. The entire clock is enclosed within a large framework, engulfed by the towering waves of urban skyscrapers.
Metropolises resemble black holes, devouring those who harbor ambitions or seek to change their current circumstances.

Time, perhaps a concept we have created ourselves,

much like how language emerged as the defining factor for all things. In my country, the younger generation faces numerous challenges from both personal and professional aspects, and it seems as if each person's life trajectory has been replicated. I designed this clock to convey to every user that, while they gaze at the time, they are also contemplating their own lives, sparking the ultimate reflection on the meaning of life.



Context

In a post-pandemic era influenced by artificial intelligence, and many societal issues have come to the forefront. People are often driven to pursue their livelihoods, with the challenges of modern life becoming increasingly apparent. Consequently, individuals continually push past their limits, engaging in excessive work and competition. Regardless of age, gender, education, or profession, it seems as though carbon-based life on this blue planet is controlled by a high-intensity, mechanized, and programmed system and operation.

Therefore, I aspire to utilize the mediums of art and design to convey current societal issues surrounding us, drawing inspiration from commonplace items and everyday objects to stimulate individuals' introspection regarding one's own value, life and aspirations.

Sketch

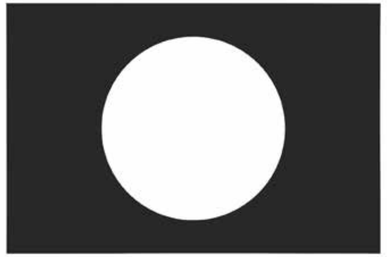
In Chinese culture, a work of art relies three parts on the painting and seven parts on the mounting. Therefore, when the concept of a picture frame entered my field of vision, I conceived the idea of incorporating it into a product. Influenced by Scandinavian design and normcore fashion, I drew inspiration from the common clock in everyday life to design this clock with artistic characteristics.



An ordinary, assembleable clock



A self-customized and assembled picture frame



Cut a cardboard of the same size as the picture frame and remove the central portion for the clock face



fix the cardboard and clock face, and create the details

Experiment

Eastern aesthetics emphasize the harmony of the circular and the square, with the structured nature of a frame providing a sense of angular boundaries. Time, like a continuous cycle, keeps evolving without pause.











Introduction

Cycle

2022

acrylic painting, gouache, installation

The inspiration for this design comes from the story and my personal insights of the famous Pixar film "Coco" (2017). The young boy's determination to pursue his dreams is unwavering, but as he embarks on a series of adventures in a different world when he gets closer to his beautiful dream, he realizes that dreams can sometimes become an obsession. The colourful world he pursued throughout his life eventually becomes a fleeting illusion, and what truly deserves our appreciation may be the ordinary, small, yet precious things around us. Life seems to be a constant climb, much like ascending a staircase, but the struggle ultimately leads to the realization of our dreams---"the colourful world", so we ride the "elevator" to soar upward. For many, the end of their dreams coincides with the twilight years of life that are just around the corner.

In the universe, human existence is a relational presence. As members of society, our interdependence



Experiment

with all things (elements) in our surroundings—whether tangible or intangible, concrete or abstract—is intrinsic. In this work, each viewer









Details

has the opportunity to envision themselves as the protagonist of the story. What significance does each juncture in life hold in relation to the interactions with the myriad entities of the world?





Introduction

This art installation is created entirely from recyclable materials. The "brain" of this installation is crafted from recycled newspapers, books, and magazines, transformed into pulp and solidified with adhesive. It symbolizes how knowledge has shaped and elevated our thinking. It is through knowledge that we have achieved scientific breakthroughs, leading to the creation of smartphones and the internet. However, as technology continues to advance, it seems that silicon-based life is now dominating our existence, akin to a fisherman casting a vast "net" of the internet to capture and confine humanity. Traditional paper-based books, once the catalyst for human progress, have now become a lasting but past foundation.

Fishing

2022

mesh food covers, fishing net, discarded newspaper, branch, cell phone, books, acrylic colours

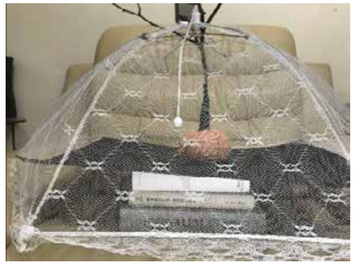
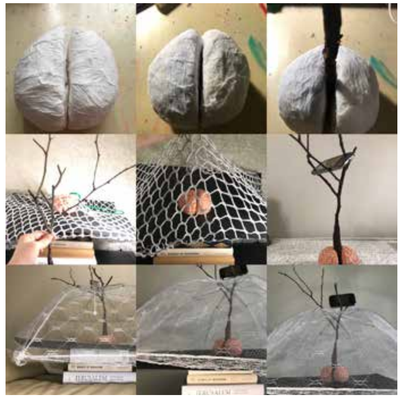


Experiment







Details










Introduction

This work is a multimedia composition, and my inspiration draws from the bizarre and exaggerated details seen in "Rick and Morty" and the attire of the Plague doctor or Doctor Schnabel during the late Middle Ages and the Renaissance, a period when the Black Death was rampant. The Plague doctor's outfit was designed to ward off the plague, but sometimes educators or elders tend to overlook the psychological well-being of children while pursuing educational goals.

Where do eggs come from, and where do they go?

June, 2022

around 70cm*80cm

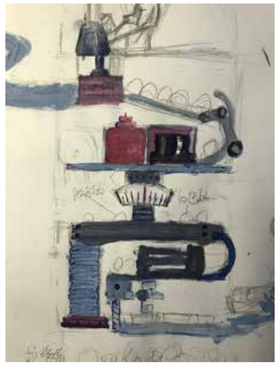
Gouache painting, colored pencils, markers, and collage on paper

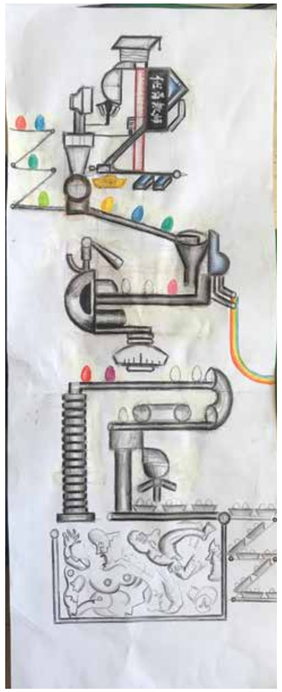
At times, when we contemplate what education has brought to us, we realize that it has transformed us into mass-produced products, much like eggs, rather than allowing us to become our true selves. In creating this piece, from the initial composition to the finished product, I employed various artistic techniques such as collage, cutting, and colours. The intention is to prompt individuals to reflect on the essence of education, advocating for reforms that lean toward diversity, uniqueness, flexibility, and interdisciplinarity, thereby decreasing the hierarchy in education.



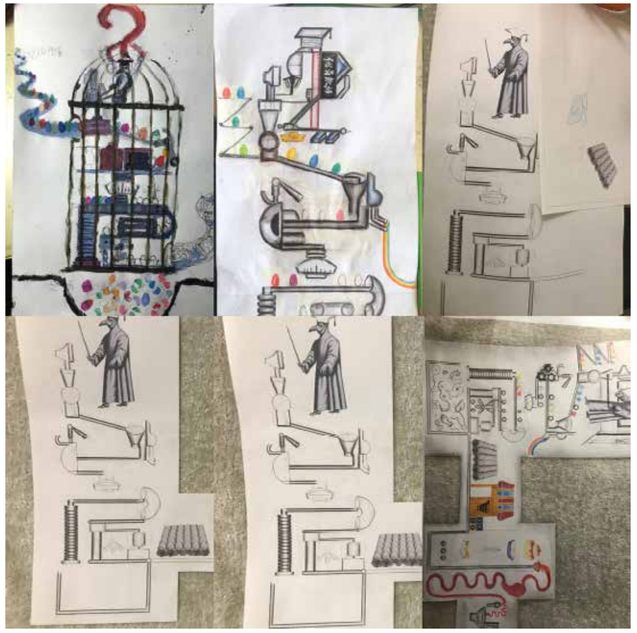
Sketch







Experiment



CULTURAL-CREATIVE DESIGN & VISUAL COMMUNICATION DESIGN

Dreams

Introduction

This installation is combined with painting enclosed in a box with a small light, and its inspiration draws from the story of "The Lord of the Rings." However, in this adaptation, the central character is not only Frodo Baggins, but also myself. Under the influence of this book, my interests were sparked in both biology (represented by the microscope) and the humanities (including castles, sound systems, cubist books, chess pieces, and letters). Eventually, this "ring" led me to my true passion, the realm of art and design.

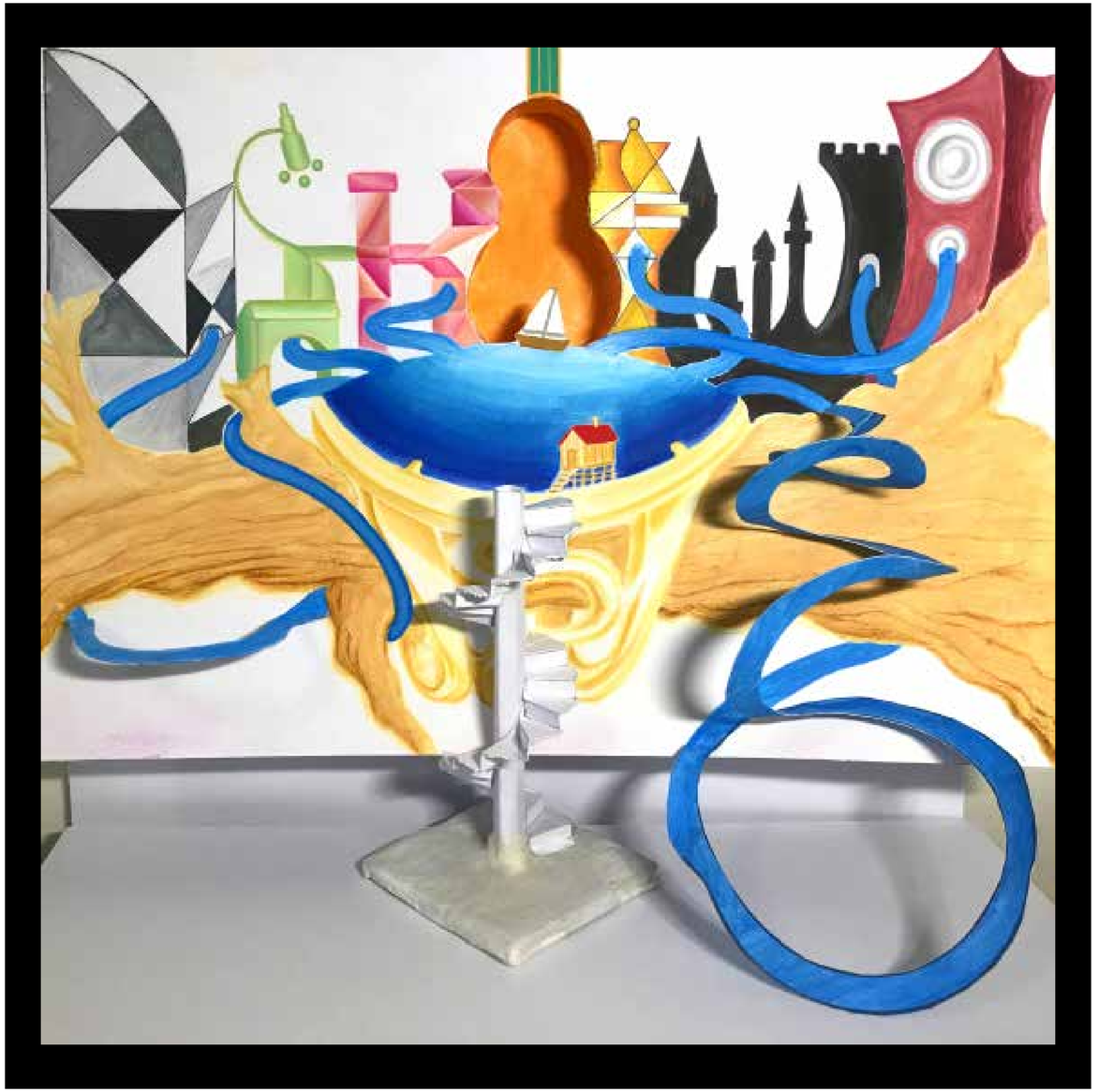
The miniature spiral staircase is an installation I designed and created myself, symbolizing the arduous journey of "The Fellowship of the Ring" and, by extension, my own pursuit of dreams.

Destiny

2022-2023

30cm*22cm

Acrylic painting, gouache, coloured pencils, and markers on paper with installation, card paper



Sketch

This artwork can be perceived as a three-dimensional stage. The front layer features a substantial spiral staircase, symbolizing the hardships endured by characters like Frodo. The second layer consists of two-dimensional representations of the ring and dreams, signifying that the all-powerful ring is merely a transition rather than the ultimate goal. The third layer is an inwardly concave guitar-shaped "shore of success".









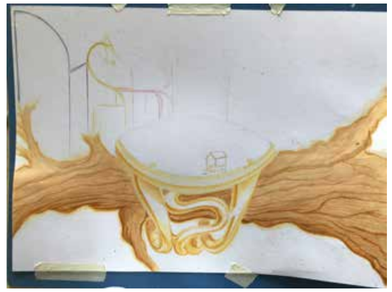
Experiment & Details















Context

A Chinese-style tobacco pipe disrupts the space-time continuum

2022-2023

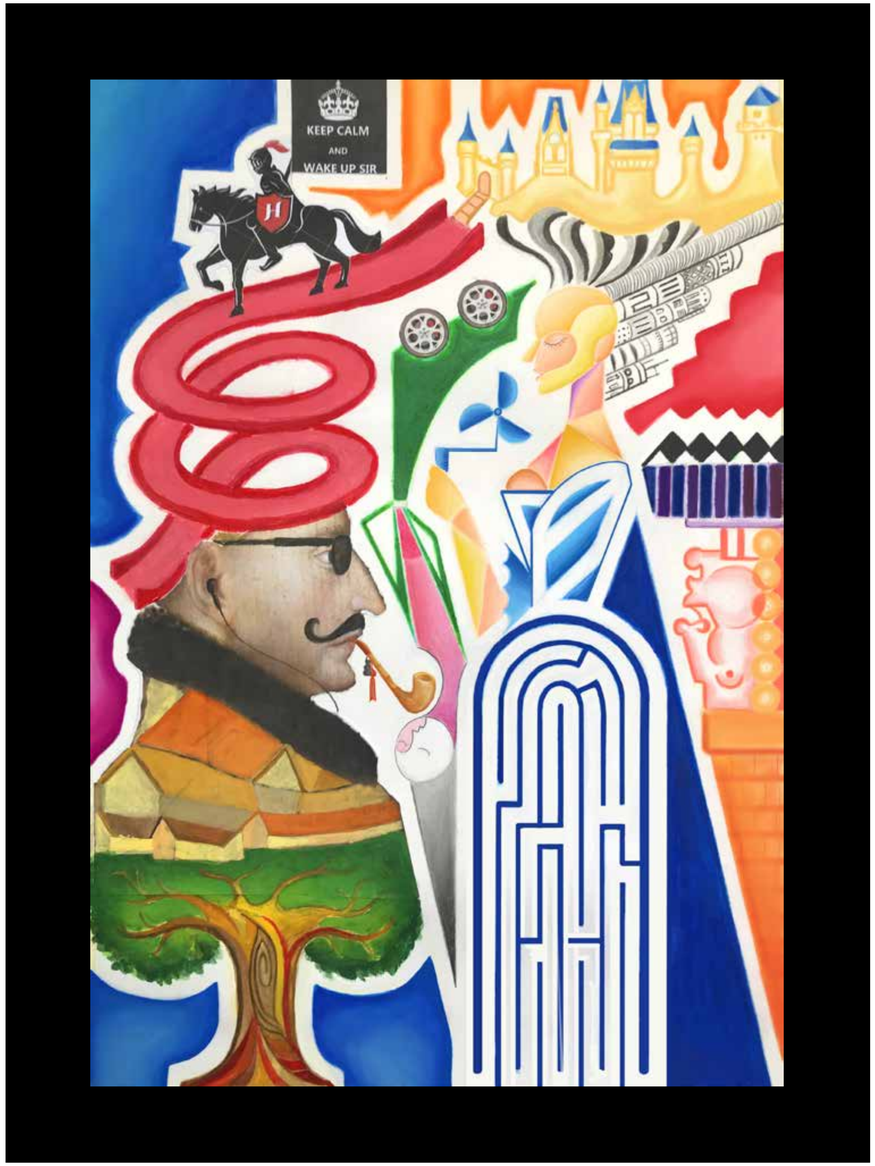
40cm*28cm

Redone and polished by Photoshop, acrylic painting, gouache, coloured pencils, mark pens and collage on paper

Today, many ancient traditions are gaining favor among the younger generation, sparking a retro trend. In China, young people are donning traditional Hanfu attire, taking up hobbies like tobacco pipes, and showing interest in old and even outdated pastimes. Inspired by this, I thought of promoting the traditional Chinese dry pipe （旱烟斗） in a whimsical and culturally-rich illustrated manner.

Introduction

In this work, a gentleman from the late 14th century is depicted enjoying a traditional Chinese dry tobacco pipe, gradually entering a "dreamland" (as illustrated in the work). His elegance captivates ladies from various eras, and eventually, his knight navigates the "maze" of a lady's dress and his chaperon, awakening him. Seemingly inconspicuous, the pipe is the thread/clue, the fuse/trigger, and the centre of the entire story. The knight's attire features the meme from World War II, adding a twist to the narrative.



Sketch





Experiment







Who am I, where am I, what am I doing?

2022-May, 2023

different colours with digital art (Photoshop)

Introduction

This work amalgamates diverse cultural elements, including historical clothing, novels, fairy tales, cubism, animation, and everyday objects. Drawing inspiration from Picasso's paintings, it seeks to depict the interpretation of human dreams—encountering multiple personalities, embodiments, and attributes of oneself within the dream realm. Just as in the Tang poem, 'Life is as unreal as Zhuangzi's dream as a butterfly,' (Lavish Zither (by Li Shangyin circa 813—858). However, this piece resonates in harmony, echoing the surreal nature of existence and the dreamlike quality of Zhuangzi's contemplation.



Sketch





Experiment



EXTRA MEDIA VISUAL
COMMUNICATION ART

Food Synergy-Mundus Cibi

Mundus Cibi I

March-July, 2023

digital

Context

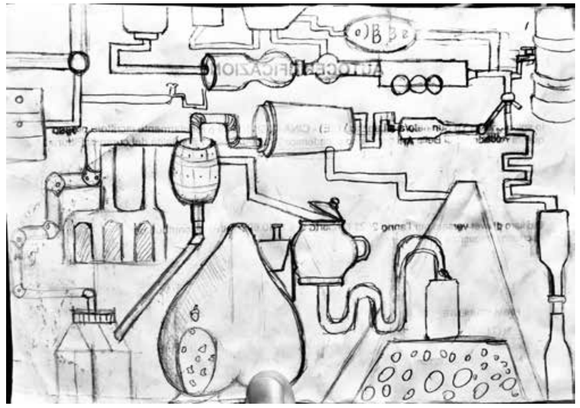
If there's one place that can consistently capture people's enduring interest, the supermarket undoubtedly stands as a prime choice. In a society tightly interwoven with commerce, marketing and consumerism extend and evolve like a double helix structure. As an ancient Chinese proverb goes: 'Food is the first necessity of the people.' (民以食为天) When it comes to the diverse array of food found in supermarkets and malls, interpreting them through artistic means adds an extra layer of intrigue and warmth. Previous designs in this realm often focused on a singular type of food product. In light of this, I envision blending various foods together to create a logically unconventional and creatively surreal environment. This approach implies a playful combination of food and dietary choices, aiming to stimulate the audience and consumers, fostering a desire for a variety of products in each consumption experience.



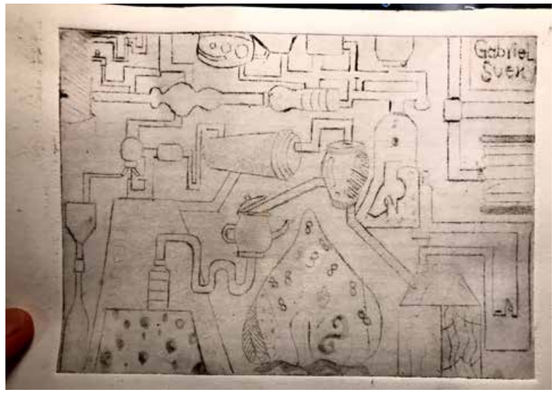
Introduction

This piece is influenced by the animated works produced by Adult Swim, particularly drawing inspiration from elements found in 'Bob's Burgers.' In an unseen parallel world, perhaps food is the inhabitant there.

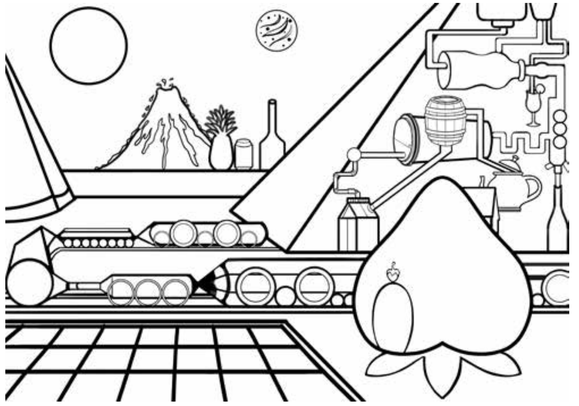
Sketch



Experiment



I also tried Calcographic engraving.



Mundus Cibi II

April & October, 2023

mark pens with digital art (Photoshop)

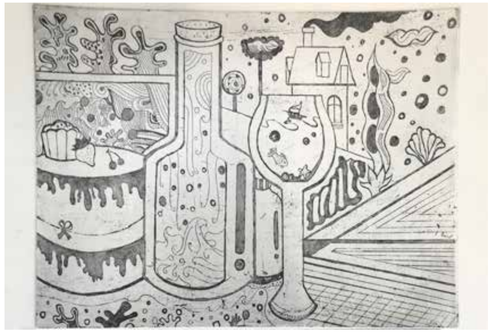
Introduction

This piece serves as a sequel to the previous artwork, adopting a different illustrative style executed with markers and refined and modified using Photoshop. Similarly, it invites viewers into a visual feast, immersing them in a fantastical world of food and beverages. Particularly inspired by film 'Cloudy with a Chance of Meatballs (2009),' whereas in my conception and the case here, the food world takes on a touch of Zen-like harmony.



Sketch





I also tried Calcographic engraving.

Experiment





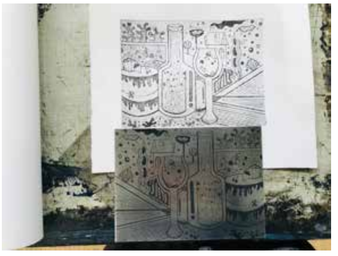




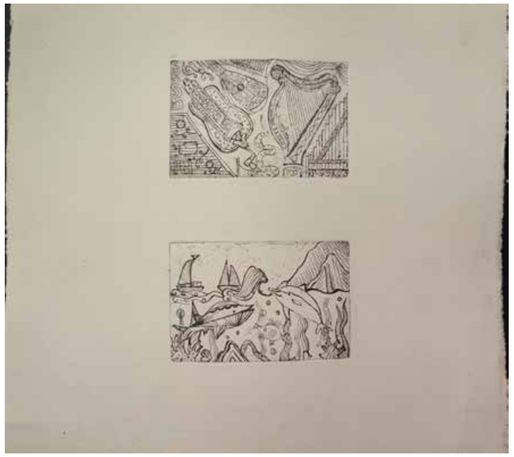


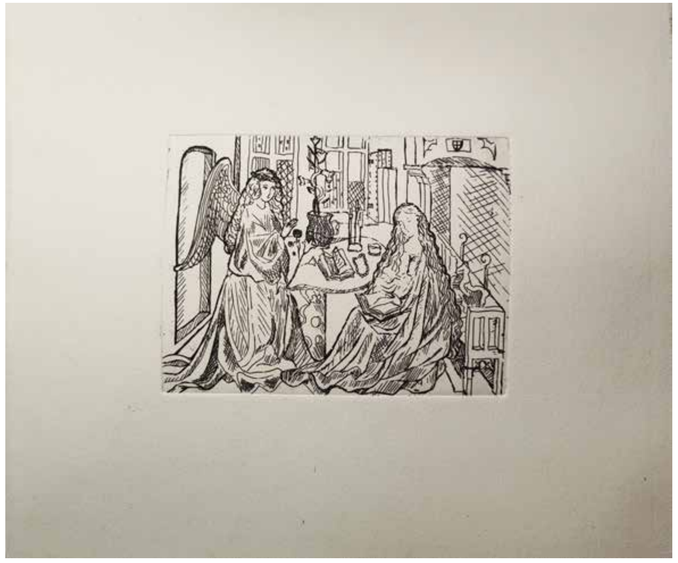


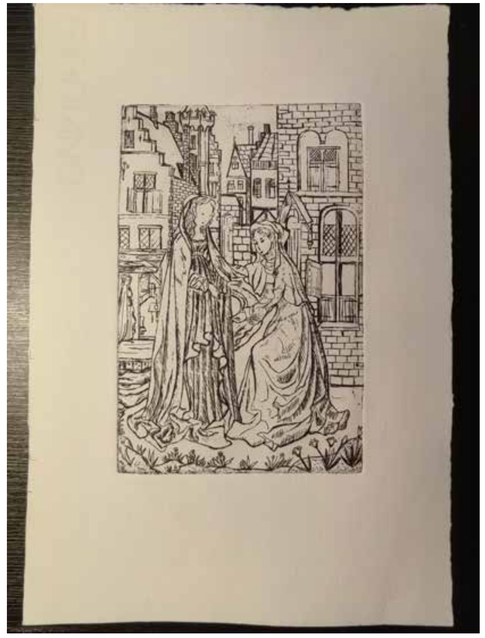
















Introduction

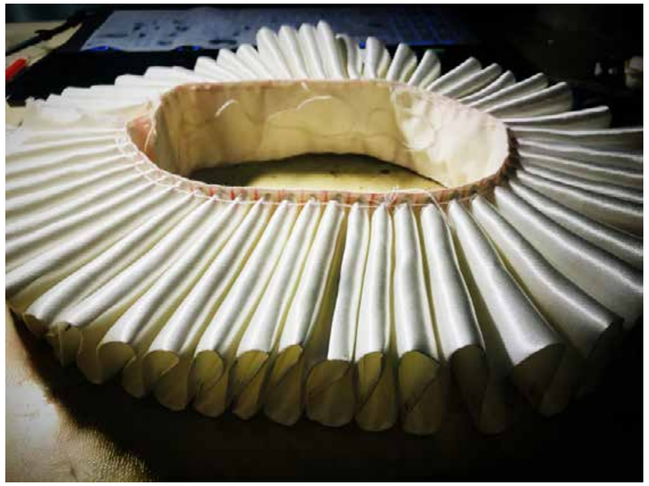
Creative Ruff Collar

Aug-Oct, 2023

fabric, needle, thread

I've been exploring historical reenactments and participating in related events for years. When admiring paintings in art galleries, I've always been fascinated by the Ruff collars popular from the late 16th to the early 17th century. Thus, this summer, I conceived the idea to create one myself. First, I purchased a 5-meter-long, 15-centimeter-wide piece of white silk fabric. I folded it along the long edge, ironed it flat, and then stitched it closed. The next step involved measuring and drawing lines with a pen and ruler. Subsequently, using a fan-folding technique, I threaded two very long, unbreakable threads through the marked points, one under and one over, creating the basic form of the ruff. This illustration is a reproduction of a work from the early 16th century that initially inspired me—the ruff worn by the woman depicted in the painting.

From its conception to the final stitch, the entire ruff is a product of my own design and craftsmanship. Aside from the initial folding process, no sewing machine was involved in bringing it to fruition.





Experiment















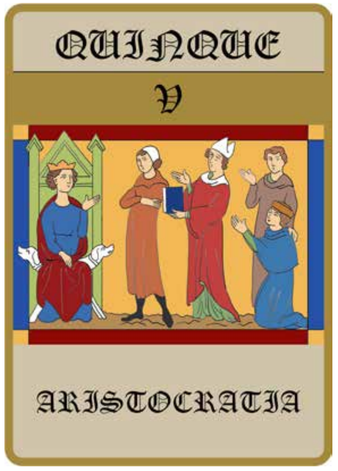


Tarot Cards

October, 2023 - January, 2024

Digital (Photoshop)

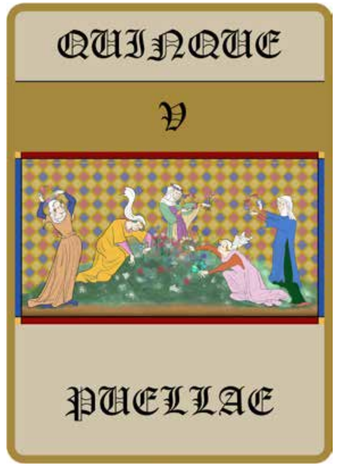






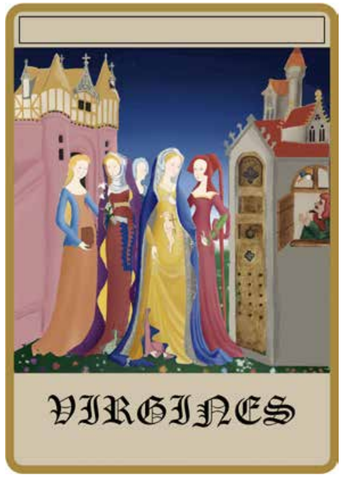














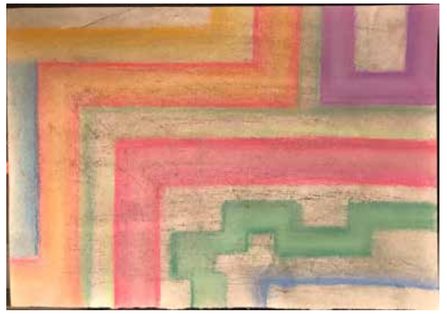
Paintings with Pastels

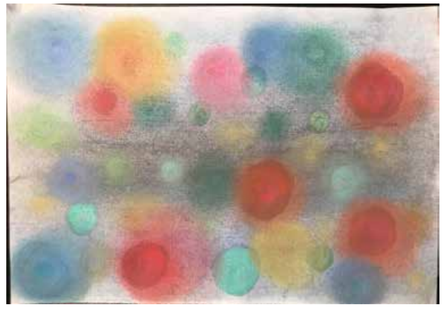
A small project-Introduction

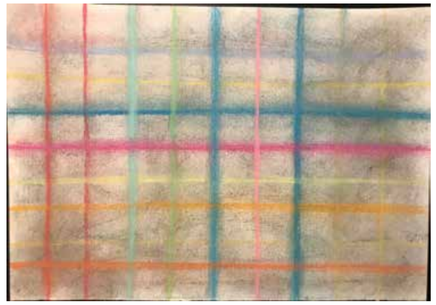
--A new try from early 2023

An art series crafted with coloured powders.

The first four pieces depict urban life: 1. Urban sewer systems; 2. Surface traffic in the city; 3. The mesmerizing city lights at night; 4. The diverse array of goods within an urban marketplace. The fifth piece illustrates a deluge.



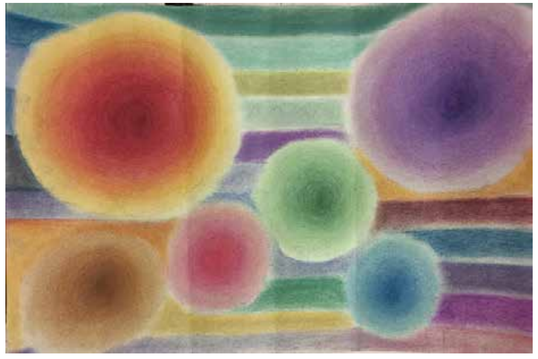










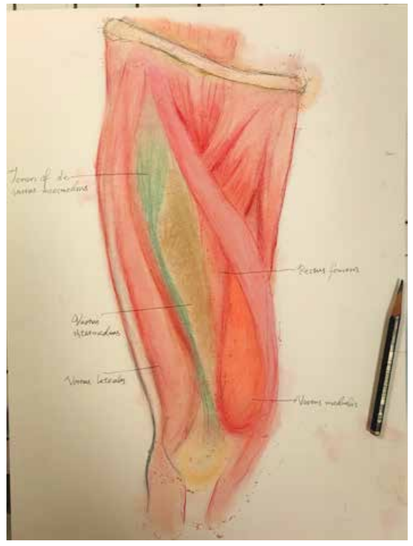






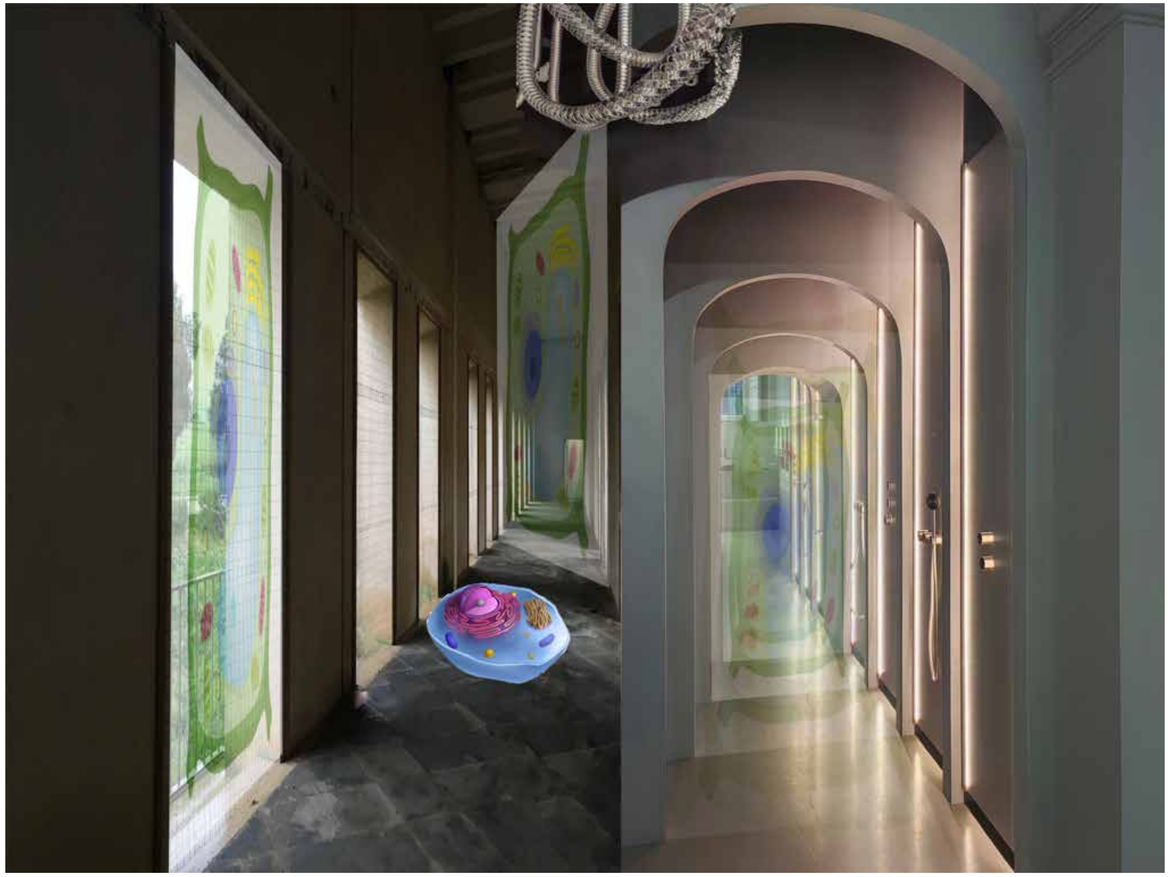












Recent work







Art is essentially a response to society through experimentation. The theme of this work is an exploration of color itself and an analysis of its meaning in different contexts.

Thirteen years ago, a fortuitous opportunity introduced me to the world of European medieval art. I was particularly captivated by the miniatures in illuminated manuscripts. These works convey a unique allure, distinct from the traditional definitions of classical Western art. In them, I discovered a purer and bolder use of color, reminiscent in some ways of 20th-century abstract expressionism and contemporary modern illustration.

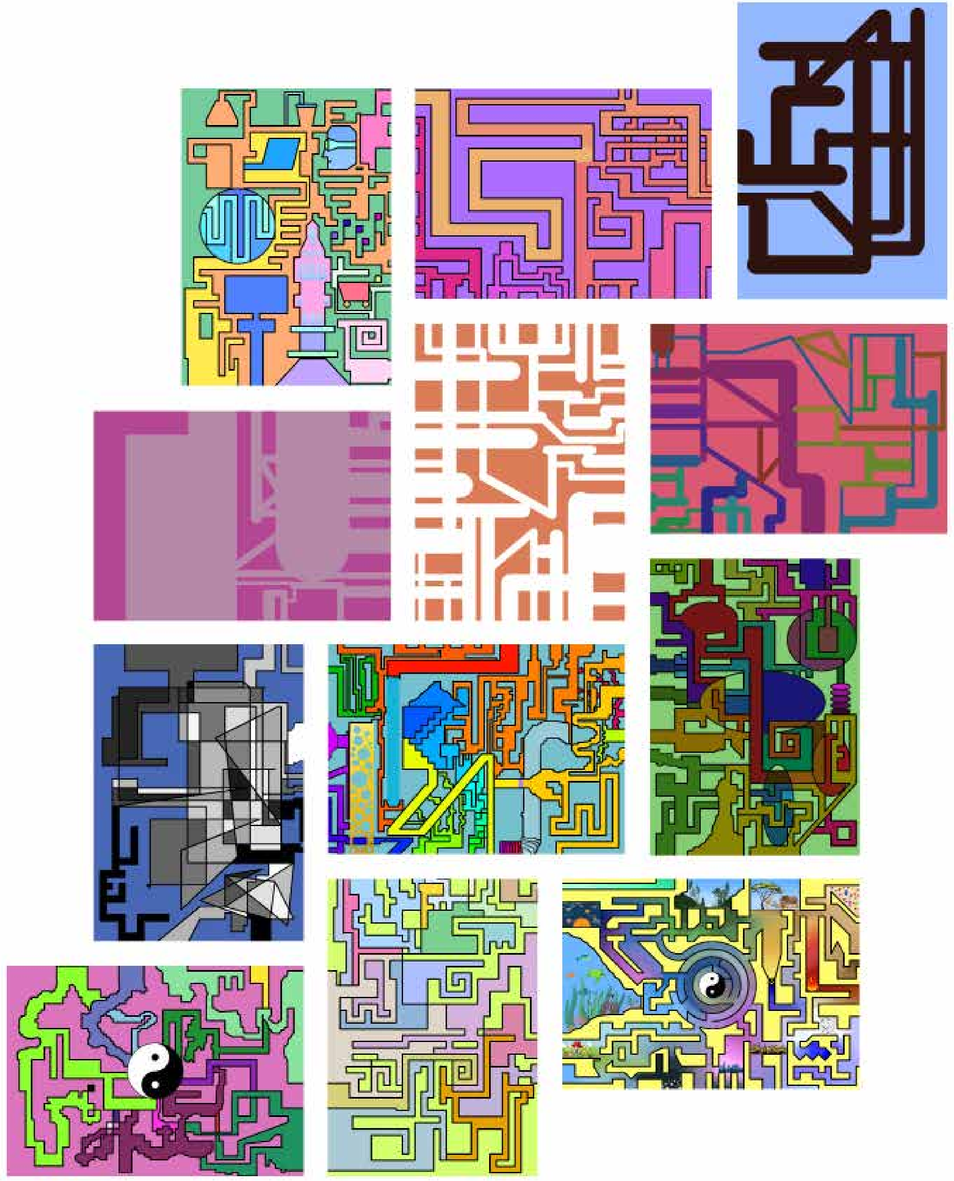
Illuminated manuscripts, as their name implies, are hand-written and hand-illustrated by artisans. They were typically created in monastic scriptoria and commissioned by churches, religious orders, nobles, and wealthy merchants. Among the most magnificent examples are the *Books of Hours*, which were widely popular between the 13th and 16th centuries.

Driven by my love for miniatures, I conceived a method to express selected illuminated manuscripts by extrapolating their colors. For this work, I chose a miniature from the *Bibliothèque universitaire de Genève*, Ms. 165, fol. 4. Parchment, 260 folios, 26.5 x 19 cm, Paris, ca. 1412–1415.



The entire concept of this work originated from pipes. Previously, I explored creating a series titled *City* using pastels, where pipes became my way of interpreting the urban environment. Often, we overlook the underground world of the city compared to its surface. Pipes possess a connective quality, and this led me to conceive *Alternative Parallel World and Twelve Nidanas*. It was this very work that inspired me to extract and connect the various colors present in the miniature.

In particular, it made me think of the techniques used in crafting medieval stained glass windows. Additionally, another detail derived from the miniature caught my attention: the decorative ribbon appearing on the canopy of the royal bed. I have not yet found a precise explanation for the embroidered motifs on the bed canopy, but it reminded me of the heraldic symbols that characterized families during the medieval era—a time of knights and chivalry.





Biblioth è que universitaire de Gen è ve,Ms. 165, fol. 4.
Parchemin · 260 ff. · 26.5 x 19 cm · Paris · ca. 1412-1415



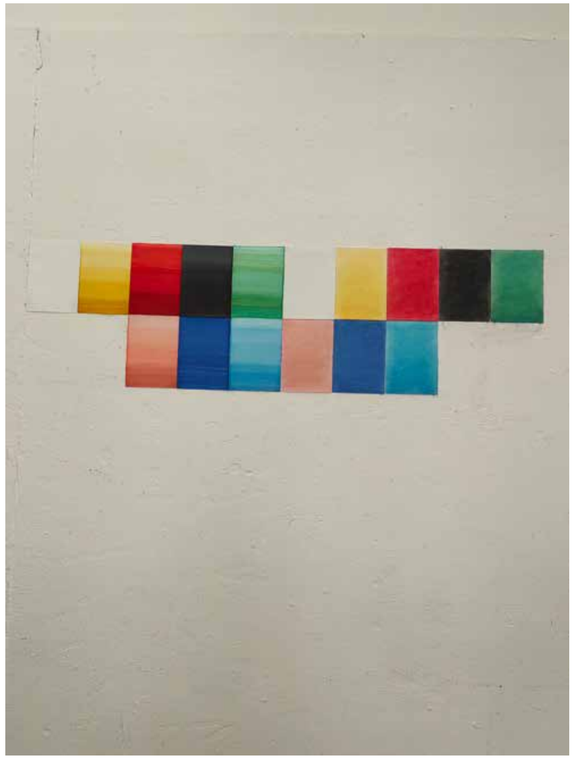
Selon mamteſſois et en pluſeurs mames par vraie experience Ie fait auons veu et apperceu le grant deſir et la bonne voulente que vous auez au bien de nous et de mē royaume tant par les morales auctorites exemples et hiſtoires a nous par vous allegueés

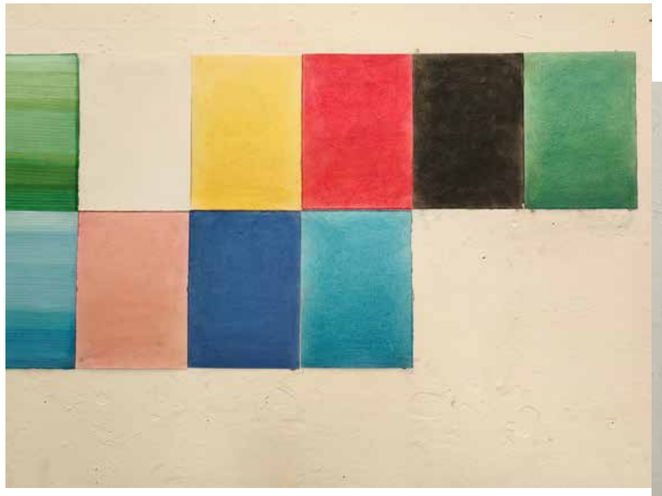
This work represents a dialogue between the colors of antiquity and those of today.

I attempted to recreate medieval miniatures using contemporary painting materials (pastels, markers, and acrylics), but I consistently encountered discrepancies in the colors. Through this artistic experiment, I aim to highlight the uniqueness and irreplicability of each pigment and color, much like the singularity of every element in nature.

Moreover, despite the centuries that have passed and the technological advancements that have produced new pigments, it remains challenging to truly replicate the techniques or cultural heritage of the ancients. Sometimes, when we look back at the past, we must gather the experience of specific eras and humbly learn from the "memory" of the ancients.

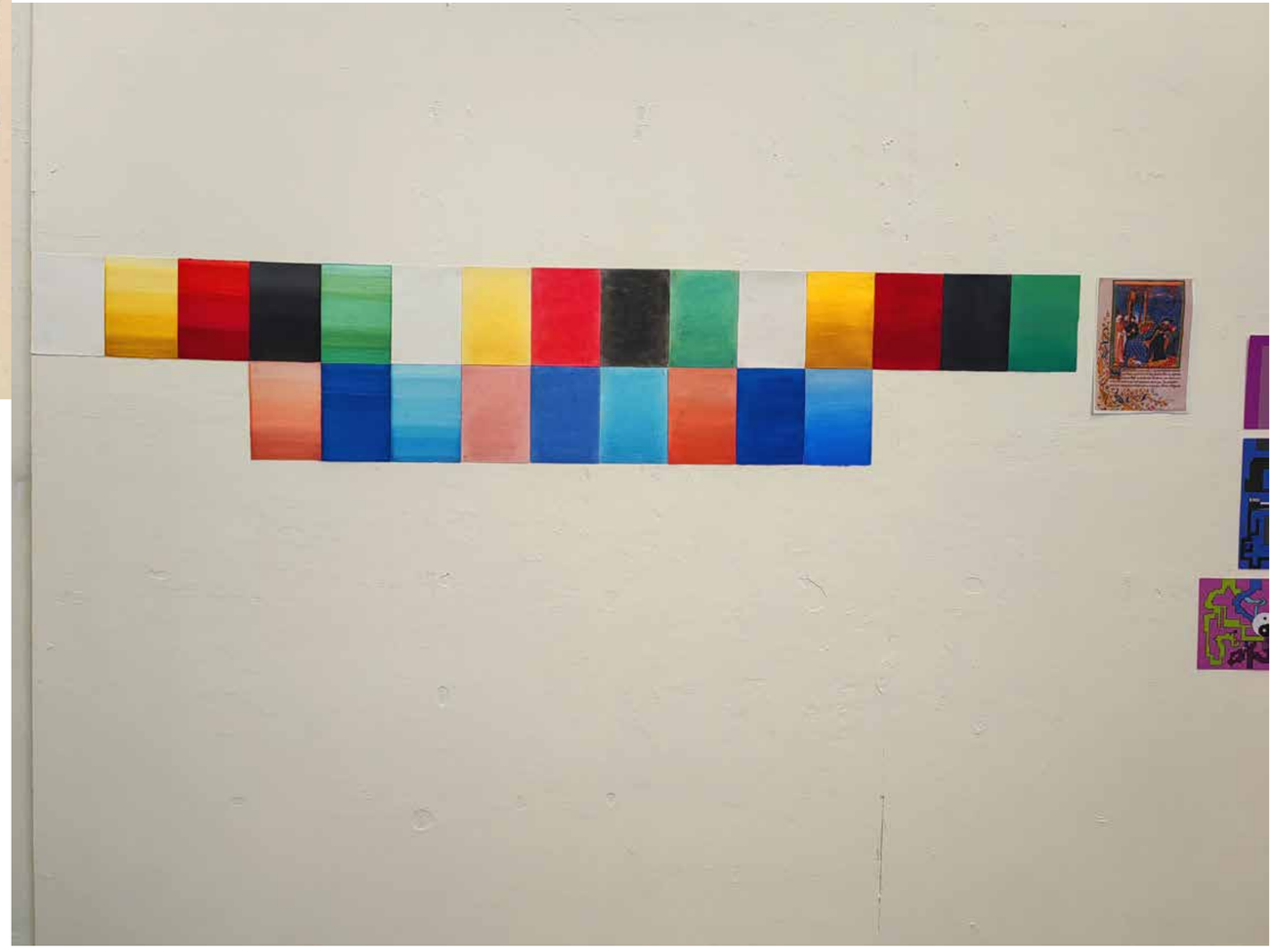












On a deeper level, through the exploration of color, I address social competition and selection. Here, the miniature serves as a reference point, with other colors striving to match it. Similarly, we tend to imitate others to conform to a "standardized" way of life and meet societal expectations. However, just as pigments cannot replicate the purity and uniformity of others due to their inherent uniqueness, the same applies to people. From the very beginning of life, we are destined to differ in the finer details.

Yet, these differences are often subject to intervention and manipulation, striving to achieve an idealized state dictated by the forces of intrusion and control, often leading to less-than-ideal outcomes. In a society that defines and dominates through classifications, boundaries, and labels, perhaps it is time to cultivate an impartial and unaligned mindset.

Thanks!